

Tracking a sale to the checkout

How a Pluggz link follows a shopper to the point of purchase · prepared for Lisa and Rachael · 11 August 2026

The short answer

Yes, and most of it is already built and running. Every Pluggz link already carries a reference that is unique to the individual click, and that reference is already arriving at the brand's website on every visit we send them. The commission engine, return windows, payout pipeline and dashboards are all built around it.

What is missing is one message coming back the other way: the brand's website telling us the order completed. That message can only be sent by the brand, because their checkout is the only place it can be seen. It is a one-time job of well under an hour on their side, and it replaces the spreadsheet entirely.

What already happens today

This is a real link on the live site. A shopper taps **pluggzofficial.co.uk/golj4vu8d3k** and in the same instant:

A click is recorded	Time, creator, product and link. Bots are excluded, so nobody's numbers can be inflated
A 30-day cookie is set	So a shopper who comes back a fortnight later still belongs to the creator who sent them
The shopper reaches the brand	<code>auvodka.co.uk/.../au-vodka-cocktail-shaker-set?ref=pluggz&pz=cmsnwhf8z0001ks24dkvv7dfl</code>

That **pz** value is the whole mechanism. It is unique to that single click by that single shopper on that creator's link, and it is already being handed to every brand we send traffic to, and has been since launch.

Everything after the sale is built and waiting

- A sale record that points back at the exact click that earned it
- Commission split at the moment of sale, at the rates in force that day, so a later rate change can never rewrite what a creator has already earned
- Each brand's own return window, so a sale only becomes payable once their refund period has passed
- The payout pipeline (Pending, Verified, Paid to Pluggz, Paid to Creator) and the 1st and 15th payout runs
- Creator dashboards, admin analytics and brand invoices, all reading from those records

None of it has ever had a sale to work on. The engine is built; nothing has been able to start it automatically.

Why the brand has to take part

Once a shopper leaves `pluggzofficial.co.uk` and lands on the brand's website, Pluggz has no code running on that website. We cannot see their basket, their checkout or their order confirmation, for the same reason no website can see inside another one. The browser does not allow it, and no amount of clever link

building changes that.

This is not a Pluggz limitation. It is how every affiliate network works. Awin, Impact, CJ and Rakuten, and the creator platforms built on top of them, LTK and ShopMy, all do exactly two things: redirect the shopper with a unique reference attached, and read a message sent back by tracking the advertiser installed on their own order-confirmation page. When Awin tells a publisher they made a sale, that data came from the advertiser's website calling Awin. There is no other way for them to know it, and no other way for anyone to know it.

The difference between “a spreadsheet from the brand” and “automatic” is not a different kind of link. It is a one-time job on the brand's website that then reports every order for ever, with no human involved and it is a normal ask. Any brand that has run an affiliate programme has done it before.

Three ways to get there

Every brand falls into one of these, and all three end in the same place: sales appearing on your dashboard by themselves.

	What the brand does	What we build	Best for
A. Pluggz postback	Adds a short call to their order-confirmation page, once	1-2 days	Direct deals, every brand we have today
B. Shopify / WooCommerce app	Installs our app. No developer needed	1-2 weeks, plus Shopify's review	Smaller brands with no dev team
C. Their existing network	Nothing, it is already installed	Integration with the network's API	Brands already on Awin, Impact or CJ

A · The Pluggz postback: the one to build first

When an order completes, the brand's server sends us one message: our reference, their order number and the order value. We match the reference to the click, the click to the creator, and the sale is on the dashboard seconds later. The last page of this document is the specification, written to be forwarded straight to their developer.

B · The Shopify / WooCommerce app

The same thing, packaged so nobody has to write anything: the brand installs it and it reports orders automatically. For a small brand this is the difference between “we'll ask our developer” and “done”, and it is what would let you onboard a brand without us.

C · Their existing affiliate network

If a brand already runs a programme on Awin, Impact or CJ, the tracking is already on their site and nobody needs to touch it. We join as a publisher and pull the sales from the network. **The blocker here is commercial, not technical:** Pluggz has applied and has not yet been accepted, because the networks want to see traffic volume first. Worth pursuing in parallel, but no developer can unblock it.

Discount codes: what they are actually for

A per-creator discount code stays in the system as the fallback for a brand that will do none of the above. It needs no integration at all, and it is exactly as reliable as that brand's willingness to send a monthly report. It should be the exception, not the plan.

What we need from a brand, every time

Commercial: agreed with you

- Commission rate Pluggz earns
- Return / refund window in days. This is what decides when a creator can be paid
- Settlement terms: how long after a sale is verified the brand pays us
- **What counts as commissionable:** order value net of VAT, delivery and returns, or something else. It needs saying out loud, because it decides every invoice
- Currency, GBP unless agreed otherwise

Technical: needed once, from their developer

- **A technical contact.** A name and an email. This is the single thing that most often stalls an integration
- Which of the three routes they are taking
- For a network: the network name, their advertiser ID, and approval of Pluggz as a publisher on their programme
- For a postback: confirmation they can add a call on their order-confirmation page, and that our reference survives their own redirects, because some sites strip it on the way to a login or a country selector, and we adjust for that
- **One test order**, on staging or for a token amount, so the chain is proven before their first real sale

We issue each brand its own key. Nothing is public, and no brand can see another brand's figures.

Where this stands

Click tracking, unique reference to the brand, attribution cookie	Live
Sale records, commission split, return windows, payouts, dashboards	Built , waiting for an input
Sales arriving by brand report or discount-code reconciliation	Live , the admin sales import
The endpoint a brand's website calls when an order completes	To build, 1-2 days
Shopify / WooCommerce app	To build, 1-2 weeks plus review
Network integration	Blocked commercially, not technically

If a brand installs nothing at all, no affiliate platform in the world can say whether a shopper bought. Pluggz can already prove they clicked, what they clicked and that we delivered them to the product page. Whether they paid is only knowable from the brand which is why the integration belongs in the brand conversation from the start, alongside the commission rate.

For the brand's development team

Pluggz sales tracking · integration guide · everything from here on can be forwarded as it is

Pluggz sends you traffic from UK creators and needs to know which of your orders came from it. Same pattern as Awin, Impact or CJ: we tag the visit, you tell us when it becomes an order. **Under an hour's work, including a test.**

We issue you a **brand key** and a **signing secret** when your account is set up. Ask your Pluggz contact and we will set them up the same day.

Step 1 · Keep our reference when a shopper arrives

Shoppers we send you land on your own product page with two parameters added:

`https://yourbrand.co.uk/products/the-product?ref=pluggz&pz=cmshwhf8z0001ks24dkvv7dfl`

pz is unique to that click. Store it in a first-party cookie and keep it for 30 days, or whatever attribution window we agree. If you already store a click ID for another affiliate network, put ours in the same place. It is the same job.

Step 2 · Tell us when the order completes

Server to server, from your backend, once the order is confirmed and paid:

POST `https://pluggzofficial.co.uk/api/track/sale`

Content-Type: `application/json`

X-Pluggz-Key: `pz_live_brand_a1b2c3...`

X-Pluggz-Signature: HMAC-SHA256 of the exact body, using your signing secret, hex

```
{ "pz": "cmshwhf8z0001ks24dkvv7dfl", "orderRef": "1002948",
  "value": 4499, "currency": "GBP", "soldAt": "2026-08-11T09:32:04Z" }
```

value is the commissionable amount **in pence, as an integer**: 4499 means £44.99. By default that is the order total net of VAT, delivery and any discount. If your figure means something different, tell us once and we will agree it rather than guess per order.

We reply **200** with a sale id. **401** means the key or signature is wrong; **422** means we could not match the reference. Send it anyway, it tells us something is being lost at step 1. **Retries are safe**: the same order reference twice is recorded once, so a double-fired checkout cannot double-count. Refunds are the same call with a cancelled status, and in most cases the creator has not been paid yet anyway, because the return window has not passed.

We need no customer data. Please do not send names, emails, addresses or payment details We have no use for them and will discard them.

If server work is not possible

A one-pixel image tag on the order-confirmation page will do it, reading the cookie from step 1 itself. **We recommend the server call instead**: a pixel is blocked by ad blockers, does not fire if the shopper closes the tab, and cannot be signed, so it under-reports, and your numbers and ours will disagree. Use it only as a stop-gap.

Step 3 · Test it, once

- Ask us for a test link. Open it and check the pz parameter arrives and is stored

- Place an order, either on staging or a live one for a token amount
- Confirm you get a 200 with a sale id back
- We confirm at our end that it shows against the right creator, with the right value

In return you get a Pluggz dashboard showing the traffic and sales we have sent you, the commission owed and your invoices, instead of a monthly reconciliation by email. Questions to hello@pluggzofficial.co.uk.